

EFFECTIVE MEETINGS

It is mandatory for every Leo Club to conduct both a Board Meeting and a General Meeting on a monthly basis. These meetings are essential to ensure effective planning, transparent decision-making, proper coordination among members, and the smooth functioning of the club in line with Leo protocol and organizational standards.

Leo protocol

Given below is the order of importance at meetings especially when guests are present and when having to introduce them.

Leo club protocol

- President
- Immediate past president
- Leo advisor
- Vice president
- Past presidents (according to seniority)
- Secretary
- Treasurer
- Board of directors
- Members

Leo district protocol

- District governor
- Leo district president
- Immediate past district president
- District vice president
- Past district presidents (according to seniority)
- District Leo Club Chairperson
- District secretary
- District treasure
- District chief coordinators
- District regional coordinators
- District zone coordinators
- District directors

Leo Multiple District Protocol

- International President (Elect - Lion)
- Immediate Past International President (Elect - Lion)
- International Vice President (Elect - Lion)
- Past International President (Elect - Lion)
- International Directors (Elect - Lion)
- Past International Directors (Elect - Lion)
- Multiple Council Chairperson (Elect - Lion)
- District Governor (Elect - Lion)
- Immediate Past Council Chairperson (Elect - Lion)
- Multiple Council Vice Chairperson (Elect - Lion)
- Past Council Chairpersons (Elect - Lion)
- Immediate Past District Governors (Elect - Lion)
- Vice District Governors (Elect - Lion)
- Past District Governors (Elect - Lion)
- Multiple District President (Elect - Leo)
- District President (Elect - Leo)
- Immediate Past Multiple District President (Elect - Leo)
- Multiple District Vice President (Elect - Leo)

- Multiple District Chairman for Leos (Appoint - Lion)
- Past Multiple District Presidents / Advisory Panelist (Appoint - Leo)
- Immediate Past District President
- District Vice President (Elect - Leo)
- District Chairman for Leos (Appoint - Lion)
- Past District Presidents / Advisory Panelist (Appoint - Leo)
- Multiple District Secretary (Appoint - Leo) (If he/she is PDPs they will be recognized before the PDPs)
- Multiple District Treasurer (Appoint - Leo) (If he/she is PDPs they will be recognized before the PDPs)
- District Secretary (Appoint - Leo)
- District Treasurer (Appoint - Leo)
- Multiple Council Officers
- District Council Officers
- Lions Club President
- Club President
- Immediate Past Club Presidents
- Vice President
- Leo Advisor / Staff Advisor
- Club Secretary
- Club Treasurer

Lions club international official protocol

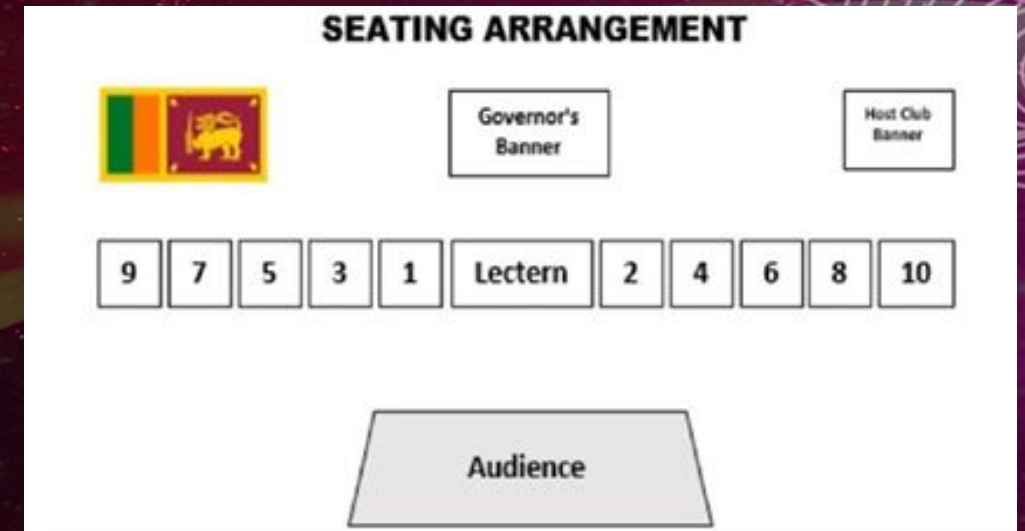
- International President
- Immediate Past International President/LCIF Chairperson
- International Vice President (according to rank)
- Past International President
- International Director (Board Appointee)
- LCIF Board of Trustees
- Past International Directors
- Past LCIF Trustees and Past Board Appointees
- GLT/GMT/GST/GET/LCIF Constitutional Area Leader, New Voices
Constitutional Area Chairperson

Head table seating

- The presiding officer or meeting chairperson must always be seated at the most central seat at the table, seat number one in the shown diagram.
- The Chief Guest and the Guest of Honor would occupy seat number one and two respectively, then other Leo dignitaries in accordance with the general order of precedence.
- If possible, there should be the same number of seats to the right and left of the chairman or presiding officer (who would normally be the Club President, District Governor, Council Chairperson or International President).

Central seat - Chairman of the meeting / Club President

1. Chief Guest
2. Guest of Honor



Club Board Meeting

1. Calling Dignitaries to the Head table
2. Meeting Called to order
3. National Anthem
4. Pledge of Allegiance
5. Leo Pledge
6. Secretary Report
7. Reading of minutes of the previous board meeting and its adoption
8. Matters arising out of the minutes
9. Treasurer's Report
 - Financial Statements
 - List of members in arrears
 - Approved bills of payments
10. Committee Chairman's reports
11. Address by the President
12. Closing Remarks by the Leo Advisor
13. Open forum
14. Vote of thanks
15. Termination of the meeting

Club General Meeting/ Special Meeting

1. Calling Dignitaries to the Head table
2. Meeting Call to order
3. National Anthem
4. Pledge of Allegiance
5. Leo Pledge
6. Introduction of Head table
7. Self-Introduction by Leos
8. Welcome Address
9. Minutes of the previous general meeting
10. Treasurer Report
11. President's Address
12. Any Other Matters
13. Introduction of Guest of Honor (In case of official visits)
14. Speech by Guest of Honor (In case of official visits)
15. Introduction of Chief Guest (In case of official visits)
16. Speech by Chief Guest (In case of official visits)
17. Presentations to Guest of Honor and Chief Guest (In case of official visits)
18. Closing Remarks by Leo Advisor
19. Vote of thanks
20. Termination of the meeting

Club Election Meeting

1. Inviting the dignitaries to the head table
2. Meeting called to order by the Club President
3. National Anthem
4. Pledge of Allegiance
5. Leo Pledge
6. Introduction of the head table
7. Welcome speech
8. Secretary's Report
9. Treasurer's Report
- If these reports have been seconded prior to the meeting, no need to table it at this meeting.**
10. Constitution and Bylaws
11. Nominations & Election
12. Open Forum
13. Announcing the elected results
14. Calling the newly elected positions to the head table
15. Address by the Special Guest
16. Introduction of the Guest of Honor
17. Address by the Guest of Honor
18. Introduction of the Chief Guest
19. Address by the Chief Guest
20. Closing Remarks by the Leo Club Advisor
21. Vote of thanks
22. Termination of the meeting

Meeting Procedure

It's advisable for the Leos to closely follow instructions given Robert Rules of parliamentary procedure for effective and efficient meetings. Apart from the same following are few areas to consider before having a meeting & at the meeting itself.

- a. Planning the Meeting
- b. The Actual Meeting
- c. Follow-up

Planning

“If you fail to plan... You Plan to fail”

- Identify the objectives for having the meeting. Is it really necessary?
- Identify the target audience. Who should be invited?
- Date, Time and Venue should be arranged. This should be convenient to a majority of the attendees if not all
- All the above should be properly communicated. Notices should be sent well in advance

The Agenda

The most important aspect of planning a meeting is preparing the agenda. The entire meeting depends on it! Include every important item for discussion

- Should clearly define who handles the different items on the agenda
- Should clearly indicate the time allocated for each item of the meeting
- Should be prepared in a manner which allows all invitees to participate and express their opinions

Inviting Dignitaries to the Head Table	1 min
Meeting called to Order - Chairperson	1 min
National Anthem	2 min
Pledge of Allegiance to the National Flag	1 min
Leo Pledge	1 min
Introduction of the Head Table	2 min
Self-Introduction of Leos, Lions and Guests	2 min
Welcome Address	2 min
Reading of Previous Meeting Minutes	3 min
Treasurer's Report	2 min
Project Reports	7 min
President's Address	5 min
Any Other Matters	5 min
Introduction of Guest of Honor	2 min
Speech by Guest of Honor	5 min
Introduction of Chief Guest	2 min
Speech by Chief Guest	7 min
Presentations to Guest of Honor and Chief Guest	1 min
Closing remarks by the Leo Advisor	2 min
Vote of Thanks	2 min
Termination of Meeting	1 min

Suggested Agenda for a Leo Club General Meeting

Club president is responsible for facilitating meetings. Conflicts, which occasionally occur during club meetings, may be minimized by:

- a) Recognizing speakers from the floor
- b) Deciding when to bring a motion to a vote
- c) Using the gavel to maintain order
- d) Adjusting the written meeting agenda to shorten or lengthen the meeting

Agenda Point by Point

- Inviting Dignitaries to the Head Table

(Just call out the names & avoid mentioning their designations, Names should be called beginning from the lowest ranked person upwards to the Highest ranking personal. If the Chairperson of the meeting is calling out the names, then the Chief Guest's name should be read last if not the last name read out should be the Chairperson's)

“I would like to invite Leo Lion Sunera Naveed to the head table”

- Calling the meeting to Order – Chairperson

After all the dignitaries have arrived to the head table the meeting chairperson can call the meeting to order. Gong & Gavel will be used to notify the meeting start.

“I call the general meeting for the month of to order. Please rise for the National Anthem followed by the Pledge of Allegiance read by Leoand the Leo Pledge by Leo.....”

- National Anthem

Please sing both verses Both the head table members as well as the participant of the meeting has to look forward at the National flag presented at the meeting. Standing and signing will happen as per the national culture.

- Pledge of Allegiance to the National Flag

Should be repeated by the others.

- Leo Pledge

Everyone should know it by heart and join the person reading it out. Please be ready at the podium. Others should not be made to wait for you until you come up

- Introduction of the Head Table

Starting with the Chairman it should be done from the highest ranked person downwards along with their designations. It is properly done following the 'right-left-right-left' method

- Self-Introduction of Leos and Lions

If you invite a guest, it is your duty to introduce him/her to the others

- Welcome Address

Is the only item on the agenda where you greet the entire head table individually.

- Reading of Previous Meeting Minutes

Please make it as short as possible. Please go from page to page during the reading & Ask for corrections Check from the audience if the minutes are in order. Get 2 people who were present at the previous meeting to propose and second that the minutes are in order

- Treasurer's Report

Check if the Report is in order. You only 'second' a Treasurer's Report. Important to give explanations regarding the Outstanding's & Liabilities Audience is permitted ask for detail questions.

- Project Reports Club Directors,
Project Chairperson's should read out their reports of projects concluded or happening at present

- President's Address
Please make it as short and should not be a 'Project Report'. Should encourage, motivate and appreciate the members

- Any Other Matters
Secretary can make announcements of invitations received from other clubs. New ideas are generated for projects. Please get everyone to speak out

- Introductions of Guest of Honor and Chief Guest
Make it short, interesting and personalized The Leo doing the introduction should invite the person for the speech stay at the podium till they come up and shake their hands and welcome them

- Speeches of Special Guest / Guest of Honor and Chief Guest
Please maintain focus during the speeches. You have invited them for a meaningful session so listen well for the concepts & ideas of these invitees.

- Tokens of Appreciation to Guest of Honor and Chief Guest

Please give something practical and useful !

- Leo Advisor's Remarks

Should not be a speech since no one is allowed to speak after the Chief Guest addresses the audience.

- Vote of Thanks

The Vote of Thanks is 'Proposed' & NOT 'Delivered or Made'. Should not be a speech during the Meeting

Leo Pledge	1 min
Introduction of the Head Table	2 min
Self-Introduction of Leos, Lions and Guests	2 min
Welcome Address	2 min
Reading of Previous Meeting Minutes	3 min
Treasurer's Report	2 min
Project Reports	7 min
President's Address	5 min
Any Other Matters	5 min
Introduction of Guest of Honor	2 min
Speech by Guest of Honor	5 min
Introduction of Chief Guest	2 min
Speech by Chief Guest	7 min
Presentations to Guest of Honor and Chief Guest	1 min
Closing remarks by the Leo Advisor	2 min
Vote of Thanks	2 min
Termination of Meeting	1 min

General Tips

- Invite guests at least two weeks in advance
- Circulate all the reports two weeks before the meeting
- Go well ahead of time and ensure that everything is in place
- See to it that the chairs / tables / registration forms etc, are in order
- Talk and greet everyone who comes in make everyone feel welcomed
- If people with responsibilities are getting late appoint alternate people for the job start on time
- Stick to the agenda
- Speak clearly and to the point
- Avoid unwanted stories or politics don't hint at people
- Take down minutes / action by notes (Very important)
- Appreciate people for their efforts, allow everyone to come out with their ideas
- Maintain discipline and order, use the gong and gavel when needed
- Never leave the chairman's seat empty The VP or an appropriate person should take it if the president / chairman leaves the seat
- After the meeting, try to organize something different to keep the members interested Re-arrange the venue in an appropriate manner
- If refreshments are served after the meeting, make sure to appoint people in charge of cleaning up as well
- Follow up & Ensure the minutes are circulated ASAP / ASYC
- Follow up with people who were handed over tasks
- Send thank you notes / emails
- Remind them of the next meeting date

Thank you